

Contact

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nicolaspettican (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Software Development
Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Nonprofit Organizations

Languages

Tibetan (Limited Working)
English (Native or Bilingual)
Spanish (Native or Bilingual)
German (Limited Working)
Catalan (Professional Working)

Honors-Awards

BSPP Undergraduate Bursary Fund
The Manchester Bursary
Khyentse Foundation Scholarship

Nicolas Pettican

Software Engineer | Scholar | Non-Profitteer
Pune Division, Maharashtra, India

Summary

I love solving problems that matter, and I do so with modern technology. I don't like selling myself though, but let's give it a go.

Currently I am an Academic Researcher and Software Engineer bridging traditional wisdom with modern technology. I'm pursuing Buddhist Philosophical Studies at Dzongsar Monastery while conducting comparative research on Madhyamaka Philosophy in collaboration with Pune University (SPPU). I recently founded Offering Bowl, a platform connecting verified monastics with sponsors globally, preserving traditional dana relationships in the digital age.

I have 8+ years of experience leading technical teams and developing healthcare IT solutions, including trend-setting practice management software at Doc Cirrus. I graduated from the University of Manchester with degrees in Biotechnology, Bioinformatics, and minors in Business and Computer Science, and have 10+ years of experience supporting and leading nonprofits.

My current focus is on developing secure platforms for Buddhist communities and exploring how technology can serve spiritual practice and community connection.

My technical expertise: Full-stack development (TypeScript, Node.js, Vue, Bash), AWS infrastructure, product management, team leadership, and Agile methodologies.

When not coding or studying classical texts, you'll find me immersed in a paperback book (or an e-ink tablet), doing charity work or chasing the sun at the foothills of the Himalayas.

Experience

Offering Bowl

Chairman | Head of Development

November 2024 - Present (1 year 7 months)

Spain & India

Founded and developed a secure digital platform connecting verified Buddhist monastics with global sponsors, modernising the traditional practice of dana (generosity) for the digital age. Leading a volunteer technical team while managing full-stack development, AWS infrastructure management, and strategic partnerships across Buddhist institutions worldwide.

Savitribai Phule Pune University

Academic Researcher

March 2025 - Present (1 year 3 months)

Pune, Maharashtra, India

Conducting comparative philosophical research on interpretations of Nagarjuna's Madhyamaka philosophy in collaboration with Dzongsar Khyentse Chökyi Lodrö Institute. This interdisciplinary project bridges traditional Tibetan scholarly methods with contemporary Western academic approaches to Buddhist philosophy.

Research Focus:

- Comparative analysis of classical Tibetan commentarial traditions and modern scholarly interpretations of Madhyamaka
- Investigation of methodological differences between traditional lineage-based study and contemporary academic research
- Development of academic papers addressing fundamental approaches to understanding emptiness philosophy
- Collaboration with international scholars including professors at University of Pune and Western Buddhist studies experts

Methodology: Classical Tibetan text analysis, contemporary academic literature review, scholarly interviews, cross-cultural philosophical methodology

Funding: Khyentse Foundation Buddhist Studies Grant

DocCirrus

Team Lead | Senior Software Developer

September 2019 - August 2022 (3 years)

Berlin Area, Germany

Led development of innovative healthcare IT solutions, including inSuite, a next-generation practice management software for medical institutions. Managed cross-functional development teams using Agile methodologies while delivering full-stack solutions that improved healthcare workflows for doctors and medical practices.

Key Achievements:

- Led containerization initiatives and technical infrastructure modernization using Docker and Unix systems
- Developed scalable healthcare applications using JavaScript, Node.js, and MongoDB
- Collaborated closely with product management, QA, and customer care teams to deliver user-centered solutions
- Mentored development team members and coordinated project component responsibilities

Implemented technical specifications from concept through deployment

Technologies: JavaScript, Node.js, MongoDB, Docker, Bash, Unix, Agile/Scrum

MADANA

Head of Development

April 2018 - July 2019 (1 year 4 months)

Berlin Area, Germany

- Leading the development of bespoke and innovative software products at MADANA, a data integration startup that aims at creating the best data privacy-enhancing technology.
- Driver of the healthcare pilot project aiming at enhancing data analytics within the Life Sciences industry while enhancing patient's data privacy.
- Responsibilities include team leadership, software development, infrastructure (Bamboo and AWS), project management, business development support, innovation and research and development.

Unique Insights

Head of Development

August 2017 - July 2018 (1 year)

Manchester, United Kingdom

- Leading the development of innovative software tools using Machine Learning technologies.

- My responsibilities lie in the creation, management and implementation of a new software product aimed at automating communication and providing better understanding of customers.
- Half the time I was writing JavaScript with Node.js, Python for data analysis and managing infrastructure, noSQL databases and AWS services.
- The other half I was working on the tech strategy, project management, product development and internal training.

HAVAS LYNX

Research Executive

September 2016 - August 2017 (1 year)

Manchester, United Kingdom

- Worked within the Strategy team to inform the marketing strategy for global pharmaceutical clients by researching and analysing the digital landscape of the pharmaceutical and healthcare industry
- Carried out both quantitative and qualitative research and analysis; the former by creating automation scripts with Python
- Carried out extensive research and analysis on social media and website analytics for SEO to inform the marketing strategy
- Collated reports, and identified key recommendations to meet with client goals

The University of Manchester

Postgraduate Ambassador

January 2016 - August 2016 (8 months)

Manchester, United Kingdom

- Represented the student body and the University providing tours, activities, Q&A sessions and general information for prospective postgraduate students (home and international).
- Answered queries about the university, English culture and student life over emails, social media and phone calls through the Manchester Calling Campaign.

University of Manchester Students' Union

Chairman of The Bioinformatics Society

October 2015 - August 2016 (11 months)

Manchester, United Kingdom

Co-founded the Bioinformatics Society. Responsibilities included:

- Overseeing activities such as the "Code for Life" series, offering workshops on software resources for life sciences students

- Managing committee meetings to set goals and objectives and secure funding

University of Manchester Students' Union

2 years 5 months

Committee Executive of The Faculty of Life Sciences Society

October 2012 - February 2015 (2 years 5 months)

Manchester, United Kingdom

- Undertook several roles including event management, marketing, graphic design and information distribution
- Organised and managed educational and social events
- Gave regular lecture announcements in front of hundreds of people
- Helped raise enough funds to pay off a 4 figure debt the society inherited from a previous committee

Social Secretary of Oak House Halls

September 2013 - September 2014 (1 year 1 month)

Manchester, United Kingdom

- Organised and managed events and activities for Oak House Halls and Ashburne & Sheavyn House through the Residence Association and Social Junkies
- Planned and managed information distribution of the yearly Oak House Ball

University of Sheffield

Research Assistant

July 2014 - September 2014 (3 months)

Sheffield, United Kingdom

- Carried out a short BSPP-funded plant pathology project studying the wheat metabolome during fungal pathogenesis
- Practiced three-phase metabolite extraction and applied mass spectrometry for metabolite identification
- Additionally, assisted Dr Hughes in his industry-linked project aimed at improving the environmental sustainability of crop production.

Education

The University of Manchester

Master's Degree, Bioinformatics and Systems Biology · (2015 - 2016)

The University of Manchester

Bachelor's Degree, Biotechnology with Enterprise · (2012 - 2015)

Dzongsar Khyentse Chokyi Lodro Institute

Bachelor's degree, Buddhist Scriptures and Philosophies · (July 2022)